



STEP TWO: Personal contacts list

After I've crafted my blurb, I'll go through my contacts. Who should I send the message to? (eg friends, family, colleagues, a guy you met at a conference once).

Specifically I'm looking for either:

- (a) **Beneficiaries:** Contacts who can really benefit from my project, or
- (b) **Helpers:** Contacts who I think would be excited to help me ¹²

Then I put them all in a big-ass list! Eventually, you'll sort this list into categories to send customized messages – if it's easier, feel free to put them into those buckets as you go.

¹ It's category B (helpers) where I see people get stuck.
I get it: You hate asking for help.

But I would posit that you vastly underestimate how many contacts would be excited to help you. Keep in mind that a lot of folks – myself included – really enjoy helping others, even strangers who I have some affinity with. And if I'm not interested in helping you, I have the freedom to just say "no" or decline to respond – nbd. So *go ask*

² BTW, don't forget to include in that list people who generally want to help you with *anything*, even if they're not super devoted to your particular project. You might be surprised by what resources they have to throw your way.

Logistics of contact list-building:

My contacts don't exist all in one place because I'm too lazy to maintain a CRM database. So first I just wildly brainstorm a new custom contacts list from scratch based on categories A (potential beneficiaries) and B (helpers) above.

Then I go platform-by-platform and sift through connections to find the ones I forgot to list: Facebook (friends list), Twitter ("which accounts should I reach out to?"), texting platforms like WhatsApp (I look through the last 100 ppl I texted)

Below are two examples of lists of the type I'm discussing:

Example list 1: FractalU instructor list

First, a list of instructors I was recruiting for FractalU's upcoming fall semester. Most of the time, my lists look like this – a quick and sloppy note gets the job done.

Fall semester potential profs

Bold = not yet contacted

Normal = contacted

Strikethrough = no

Italics = yes

?? = awaiting reply, need to follow-up

Jina

Kuba

Mars

~~Me~~

Andrew

~~Natalie? can teach fundraising~~

Hart

~~Vangelina~~

Crichton??

Kati??

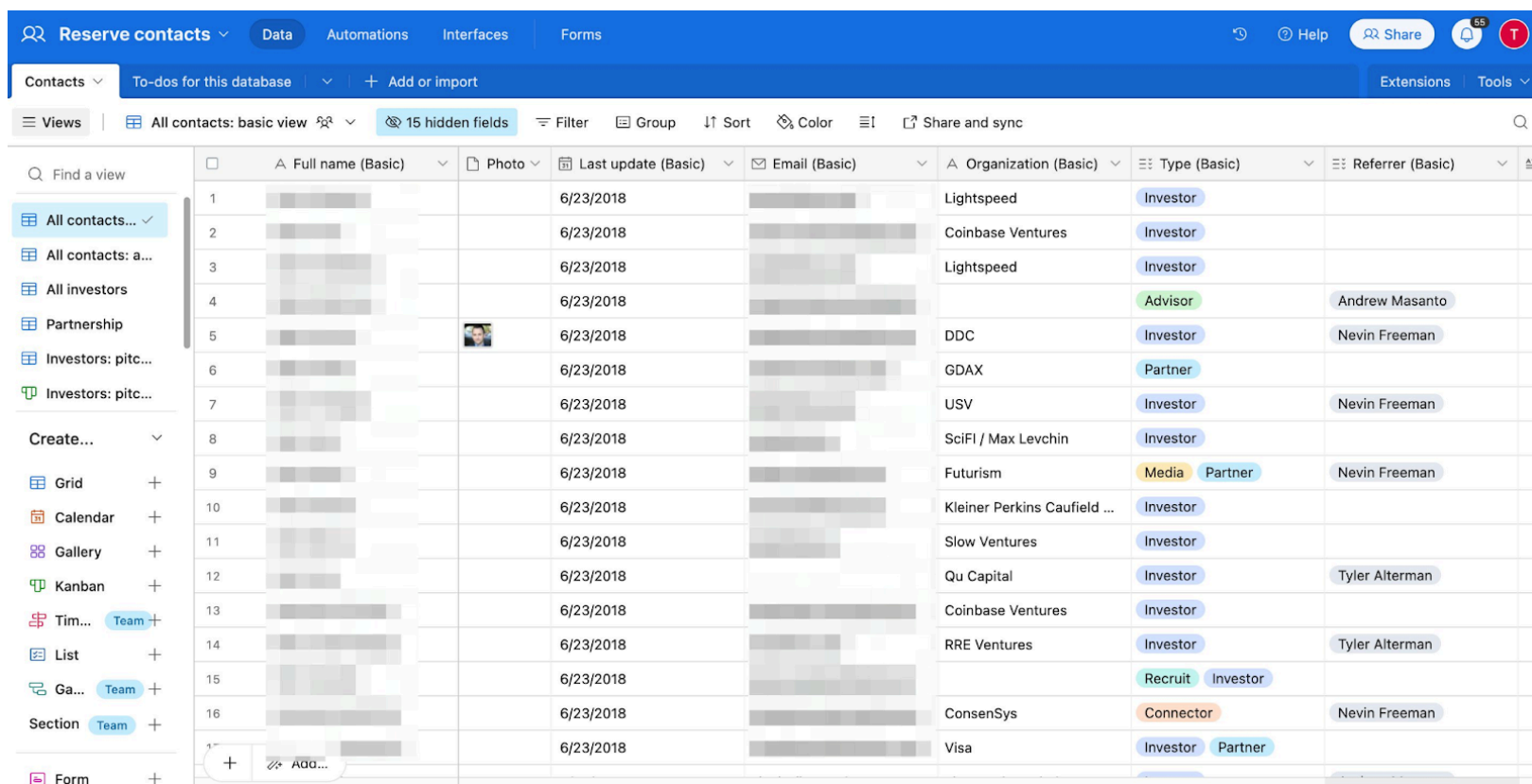
Max

Shanthi

Example list 2: Investor list

A list of investor contacts I was reaching out to while cofounding [Reserve](#).

If your list will be used by others or by you many times in the future, it's often beneficial to use a spreadsheet thing like Airtable. These let you sort, label, and assign many info fields to each contact so you can keep track of details



	Full name (Basic)	Photo	Last update (Basic)	Email (Basic)	Organization (Basic)	Type (Basic)	Referrer (Basic)
1			6/23/2018		Lightspeed	Investor	
2			6/23/2018		Coinbase Ventures	Investor	
3			6/23/2018		Lightspeed	Investor	
4			6/23/2018			Advisor	Andrew Masanto
5			6/23/2018		DDC	Investor	Nevin Freeman
6			6/23/2018		GDAX	Partner	
7			6/23/2018		USV	Investor	Nevin Freeman
8			6/23/2018		SciFi / Max Levchin	Investor	
9			6/23/2018		Futurism	Media Partner	Nevin Freeman
10			6/23/2018		Kleiner Perkins Caufield ...	Investor	
11			6/23/2018		Slow Ventures	Investor	
12			6/23/2018		Qu Capital	Investor	Tyler Alterman
13			6/23/2018		Coinbase Ventures	Investor	
14			6/23/2018		RRE Ventures	Investor	Tyler Alterman
15			6/23/2018			Recruit Investor	
16			6/23/2018		ConsenSys	Connector	Nevin Freeman
17			6/23/2018		Visa	Investor Partner	

On the next page, you'll build a contacts list!



Exercise: Build a Contacts List

Go ahead and brainstorm lists of potential beneficiaries and helpers that you might message. Like I mentioned, it's often helpful after an initial brainstorm to go through your contacts platform-by-platform. You might also find it useful to brainstorm contacts by sub-categories. For example, if I'm marketing a new FractalU semester, sub-categories might include: *Potential Students, Orgs That Might Advertise Our Classes, Friends Who Will Help Me Promote Anything*, etc

Beneficiaries	Helpers